

KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB

POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

Revision 1-10-24

ITEM	POLICY OR PROCEDURE
1	SAFETY: Safety of the dogs and handlers is our first and foremost responsibility. Emergency phone numbers have been posted throughout the building. A first-aid kit is on the wall between the restrooms. All dogs shall be on leash when at KCTC (including in the building, in the potty areas, and in the parking lot.) Exceptions: (1) Dogs actively working in a class when off-leash work is appropriate (for example, agility); (2) Instructors' dogs being used for demonstrations; and (3) When off-leash activity is a normal part of the class (for example, puppy socialization).
2	BITCHES: No bitches in season are permitted in classes.
3	DOGS PER CLASS: The maximum number of dogs in each class shall be determined by the Instructor, who shall inform the Training Director of the limit. Handlers in agility classes working multiple dogs must either pay for each dog separately, or only work one dog per sequence. Only one dog may be enrolled per Instructor/Assistant Instructor for a class being taught by that Instructor/Assistant. This does not apply to dogs used for demonstration purposes.
4	AGGRESSIVE DOGS: Aggressive dogs shall be dealt with in accordance with the "Policy for Aggressive Dogs," Appendix A.
5	POTTY: Handlers should potty their dogs in the front potty area before entering the building.
6	DOG ACCIDENTS: All handlers are responsible for cleaning up after their dogs and disposing of it properly, as follows: put papers towels used for urine clean-up in a plastic bag and then put the plastic bag inside a trash can, and put all stool in a separate bag and throw it away outside in a covered trash can.
7	UNATTENDED DOGS: No person, member or non-member, is ever permitted to leave a dog in the building unattended.
8	CHILDREN: Children shall be at least 13 years old to work a dog and all children under 16 shall have a parent present, at all times, when working a dog. The only exceptions to this are (1) if the children are attending a specific class geared to children only, or (2) if the instructor agrees to allow a child under 13 in the class. The instructor may also evaluate the child during the first class before making a final decision on allowing the child to continue in the class.
9	BUILDING USAGE: The Building Usage page of the website shall list all the people who use the building during non-class hours, seminars, special events, etc., along with the lead person for such events.

10	CHANGES: Changes to this Policies and Procedures document require Board approval.
11	RECOMMEDATIONS: A person wishing to propose a recommendation to the Board for approval should send an email to all Board members and should use the words "PROPOSED ITEM FOR BOARD APPROVAL" in the subject of the e-mail. That person should also specifically say in the e-mail what the item or recommendation is and include or attach any supporting documentation. Suggested wording is "I am requesting Board approval for . . ." The club President will include the request on the agenda for the next board meeting where a discussion will take place and a vote taken or more information will be requested.
12	BOARD EMAIL VOTES: The KCTC Board may conduct business by e-mail, in accordance with Appendix B.
13	DROP-INS: The class drop-in fee will be as stated on the class price list on the website. A liability waiver must be signed by all non-member drop-ins, upon arrival at each class. All drop-in fees collected are to be left at the club and are to be placed in the cash box. Anyone planning to drop-in on a class should first check to be sure the class is not at maximum capacity. If the class is not full, the instructor must be notified of the drop-in's intent. The instructor will keep the class size to the limit stated on the CLASS SCHEDULE page of the website.
14	PRIVATE LESSONS: Private lessons may be given on a voluntary basis by Instructors or Assistants at the club, not at the client's home or at the Instructor's or Assistant's home. The cost will be \$25 for a one hour session, payable to the club. Private lessons will be given when no other classes are in session at the club.
15	EMERGENCY PROCEDURES: Emergency phone numbers have been posted throughout the building. A first-aid kit is on the wall between the restrooms. An Incident Report should be filled out for any emergency or injury.
16	CLUB MAILING LIST: The Bylaws require Board approval of the use of the club mailing list. This is clarified as follows: Board approval is not required to use the club mailing list for normal club business (such as sending the newsletter) and sending club announcements (such as information about club events). The club's mailing list (including both the street address list and the e-mail list) is considered club property. Personal messages to the membership, using either list, shall be approved by the Board. Any messages to the club membership shall be distributed by the Corresponding Secretary or his/her designated back-up.

17	CLUB PURCHASES – Board of Directors approval is required for any purchases over \$250, and membership approval (by simple majority vote) is required for any purchases over \$10,000 . Such purchases will be announced at the next general membership meeting or via the club newsletter. Exceptions include: rent, utilities, insurance, promotional advertising, postage, sales tax, concession purchases, newsletter expenses, enrollment refunds, re-saleable pet supplies, office supplies, (envelopes, printer toner, copying, diploma paper, etc.), building maintenance (bulbs, filters, cleaning supplies, paint, paper supplies, pest control, etc.), match and trial supplies (cash for change, flyers, raffle tickets, prize ribbons/rosettes, food, score sheets, judge's gifts, etc.), holiday party expenses (site rental fee, plaques), community event fee, and reimbursements to members for any of the above. A Director at Large shall be responsible for maintaining bathroom paper supplies and cleaning supplies, for keeping spray bottles full, and for keeping the water bowls clean.												
18	LAPSED MEMBERSHIP – A person or family whose membership has lapsed but wants to rejoin the club may do so by submitting a new membership application and paying the membership dues. They must also take classes at the non-member rate and be voted upon by the membership in accordance with the following: <table><tr><td><i>Time since membership has lapsed</i></td><td><i>Number of paying classes that must be taken at the non-member rate</i></td><td><i>Membership vote on the application</i></td></tr><tr><td>0 – 1 year</td><td>None</td><td>Not required</td></tr><tr><td>1 – 2 years</td><td>One</td><td>Required</td></tr><tr><td>Greater than 2 years</td><td>Two</td><td>Required</td></tr></table>	<i>Time since membership has lapsed</i>	<i>Number of paying classes that must be taken at the non-member rate</i>	<i>Membership vote on the application</i>	0 – 1 year	None	Not required	1 – 2 years	One	Required	Greater than 2 years	Two	Required
<i>Time since membership has lapsed</i>	<i>Number of paying classes that must be taken at the non-member rate</i>	<i>Membership vote on the application</i>											
0 – 1 year	None	Not required											
1 – 2 years	One	Required											
Greater than 2 years	Two	Required											
19	CLASS FEES FOR NEW APPLICANTS – An applicant who has taken two classes at the non-member rate and then submitted a membership application, may take a third class at the member rate if the class start date is prior to the date of the membership vote on the applicant.												
20	SIGN-IN SHEET – Deleted.												
21	CLASS ENROLLMENT PROCEDURE - Class enrollment will be accepted starting on the date and time posted on the website. All enrollments shall be on-line, using the links from the Class Schedule page. Instructions for enrollment will also be posted on the Class Schedule page. Classes that are full will be shown as “waitlisted” on the Class Schedule page. Problems with enrollment should be reported to the Enrollment Coordinator.”												

22	K-9ERS – The K-9ers reserve the right to approve any new participants in their group. This includes practices as well as events. Only dogs who are CGC certified may participate in K-9er or KCTC events and demos. In addition, dogs shall be TDI certified to do any visitation with individuals when that visitation is part of a K-9er or KCTC demo or visit.
23	BUILDING RENTAL – The building may be rented to members, non-members, and outside organizations. The fee is \$25 per hour for members, and \$35 per hour for others, or a different amount determined by the Board of Directors based on the nature of the event. See the Bylaws, Article XV, Section 4 for additional requirements.
24	REFERRALS – Any member who refers five new students to KCTC who enroll in classes will receive a Bonus Bone that can be redeemed for one free class.
25	FOSTER DOGS – People who house foster dogs will be charged the reduced rate of \$40 for a 6- or 7-week class. People who adopt foster dogs and keep them will be charged the regular rate.
26	ELIGIBILITY FOR AWARDS - To be eligible for a KCTC award, the dog and owner must meet all of the following criteria: a. The owner must be a KCTC member in good standing. b. The owner and dog must be listed on the current Membership List maintained by the Membership Chair. c. The dog must have earned a title in the previous calendar year (January 1 through December 31). <u>Co-Owned Dogs</u> – the above criteria apply. In addition: d. The co-owner receiving the award must be the first name listed on the dog's official ownership papers, or must be the co-owner who actually earned the title with the dog. <u>Exception:</u> this criterion does not apply to Conformation titles earned in the ring by a professional handler. e. If the first name on the dog's papers is not a member of KCTC, then no award is given regardless of who co-owns the dog. f. If there are more than two co-owners the same principles apply. Only one award will be given per dog per family at KCTC expense. Additional awards must be purchased.
27	REFUND POLICY – The KCTC class enrollment form states our

	no-refund policy. However, full or partial refunds may be given on a case-basis if approved by the Board. Guidance: the Board should not consider refunds if the student elects to miss a class or classes. But the Board should consider a refund if the instructor requests the student to withdraw from class, or due to extenuating circumstances beyond the control of the student such as an illness or injury to the student or dog. NOTE – refunds, if given, shall be in the form of a gift certificate for a future class.
28	KEYS – The President shall maintain a list of building keys. Keys are to be held by Board members, Instructors, Assistants, and cleaning personnel only. Keys shall not be lent out unless approved by the Training director or the President. Keys shall not be copied. If a key is damaged or lost, the President must authorize a new one. An Instructor or Assistant who does not teach in two consecutive session shall return his/her key to the President.
29	WAITLISTED CLASSES AND NO-SHOWS - If a class is Waitlisted, then the Enrollment Coordinator (EC) will type “WAITLISTED” at the top of the class roster so the Instructor is aware. The EC will also type the list of waitlisted students at the very bottom of the roster, in the chronological order that the students are waitlisted. If an enrolled student does not come to the first class (i.e. no-show), it is the responsibility of the Instructor to contact the EC (with a copy to the Training Director). The EC will then contact the no-show. If the no-show does not intend to come to the second (and future) classes, the EC will contact next person on the waitlist. If a student emails either the EC or info@keystonecanine.com that they will be absent from a class, or will drop out of a class, it is the responsibility of the EC to forward that message to the Instructor. It is the responsibility of the Instructor to inform the EC if any changes are made to the final printed roster.
30	LAPSED MEMBERSHIP BONUS BONES AND INSTRUCTOR PERKS – A person whose membership has lapsed may use accrued Bonus Bones and Instructor Perks within one year of the lapsed membership but shall pay the difference between the value of the Bonus Bones or Perks and the non-member class cost.
31	INCIDENT REPORTS - An Incident Report shall be completed for any incident involving an emergency, aggression, injury to dog or handler, or fall that could result in an injury. Incident Report forms are in the rolling cart in the office, and in the roster books in each room. Copies of all Incident Reports shall be placed in the mailboxes of the Vice-President and Training Director, both of whom shall be notified of the incident within 24 hours via phone call, text message, or email. The Board of Directors shall review all Incident Reports and determine if any further actions are warranted. In cases where more than one dog or handler is involved, both parties may fill out Incident Reports to give their recollections of the incident. The Instructor

	may choose to interview both parties prior to submission of the report. The Vice-President has the lead responsibility for Incident Reports and for recommending follow-up actions to the Board.
32	COLLARS AND LEASHES – Prong collars, choke collars (slip or chain) and flexible leashes such as "Flexi-leads" cannot be used at KCTC. In addition, for Agility classes, only flat buckle collars may be used, and guidance may be provided by instructors regarding the use of collars and tags at various agility venues.
33	BONUS BONES – Deleted.
34	INSTRUCTOR CONTINUING EDUCATION – Instructors and assistants are encouraged to take external training courses/classes/seminars, and may be reimbursed up to \$50, in accordance with Appendix I.
35	CELL PHONE USAGE DURING CLASSES – Talking on cell phones during classes is not allowed, because it is disruptive to the instructors and to other students trying to listen to the instructors. Cell phones can be brought into the building, but must be set on vibrate or the ringtone set to silent. In the case of an emergency, you may go outside the building or into the back hallway to make or return a call. In classes where students are on the floor individually, you may miss your turn if you leave to use your cell phone.
36	INCLEMENT WEATHER – Cancellation of classes shall be handled in accordance with the "Keystone Canine Training Club Instructors Manual" Section I.4.a. Responsibilities for notification are outlined in Section I.10. If conditions affect a Trial or Special Event the determination and notification procedure are the responsibility of the trial secretary or event coordinator, who shall also inform the club president. If conditions warrant closure of the facility as a whole, as determined by the training director and another board member an email notification to membership will be issued via the 'blaster', instructors will notify their students, and the club telephone message and the website homepage and Facebook pages will be updated.
37	SICK DOGS OR DOGS WITH COMMUNICABLE DISEASES - Sick dogs or dogs with (or suspected of having) communicable diseases such as (but not limited to) kennel cough, internal parasites, Giardia, and influenza) are not allowed in the KCTC building until the dog's symptoms of disease are gone and the dog is no longer contagious. Any dog who has visited a veterinarian for treatment for a communicable disease shall obtain the veterinarian's clearance before returning to class. In addition, to maintain good hygiene in our building, dogs should not share toys, and club crates should be wiped down with disinfectant after every use. Bringing your own crate is encouraged.

APPENDIX A: POLICY FOR AGGRESSIVE DOGS

Revision 11-20-18

1. All students are currently required to sign a liability waiver, accepting responsibility for their dog's behavior and absolving the Keystone Canine Training Club of responsibility for any injuries to people or other dogs.
2. All members are required to sign a similar waiver, as part of the membership application or membership renewal process.
3. No aggressive dogs are allowed to participate in any Keystone sponsored or affiliated demonstrations or public events.
4. In class, if a dog shows aggressiveness toward people, the Instructor shall take the following actions:
 - Advise the student to keep the dog away from other people,
 - Alert the other students to stay away from that dog,
 - Advise the student that he or she must keep the dog under control at all times,
 - Advise the student to seek additional individual outside help, and
 - At the Instructor's discretion, advise the student to withdraw from the class and refund the class fee.
5. The Instructor shall also record the incident on an Incident Report form.
6. In class, if a dog shows aggressiveness toward another dog, the Instructor shall take the same actions as for dog-to-people aggressiveness above. Examples of dog-to-dog aggressiveness may include behavior such as lunging, barking, snapping, biting, growling, and baring of teeth.
7. If a dog has an incident of aggression with another dog, the handler shall advise the Instructor. The Instructor shall take the actions in Paragraph 4 above (for dog to people aggression), and shall fill out an Incident Report and notify the Vice-President and Training Director within 24 hours of the incident, in accordance with Item 31 of these Policies and Procedures. If a member wishes to lodge a formal complaint about another member's dog, the complaint will be handled in accordance with the disciplinary section of the Bylaws.

APPENDIX B: KCTC BOARD POLICY ON E-MAIL VOTING

Revision 4-11-16

GUIDANCE FOR E-MAIL VOTING

Any member of the KCTC Board of Directors may submit a request for approval by the Board via email vote on items of an urgent nature. The use of e-mail voting will be for emergencies, or when there is a time urgency. All other items should be held for the next Board meeting.

FORMAT FOR E-MAIL VOTING

The person making the recommendation should use the words "REQUEST FOR BOARD APPROVAL" in the Subject of the e-mail. That person should also specifically say in the e-mail what the item or recommendation is and include or attach any supporting documentation. Suggested wording is "I am requesting an e-mail vote for Board approval for . . ."

RESPONSES FOR E-MAIL VOTING

All Board members shall "Reply All" to the request for an approval vote within five days of the date of the e-mail request. The response should say "Yes" or "No" (not "Sounds good to me" or words to that effect). If a Board member considers that the request warrants a discussion at the next Board meeting rather than an immediate decision, the response should say "No, defer until the next Board meeting" and the reason why. The voting process shall be exactly the same as for regular Board meetings, in accordance with the club Bylaws: (1) a quorum for a valid vote is a majority of the Board members, and (2) votes are determined by a simple majority of those voting.

DOCUMENTATION FOR E-MAIL VOTING

The person making the request shall keep track of the responses, and shall advise the Recording Secretary of the vote. The Recording Secretary shall document the vote in the next Board meeting minutes.

APPENDIX C: INSTRUCTOR PERKS

Revision 3-13-22

PERKS: Qualified instructors and assistants are entitled to:

- Free classes
- Discounted rates (20% off) on KCTC-sponsored in-house seminars
- Use of the building (see details below)
- Individual Membership Renewal (see details below)

PERKS PROGRAM CARDS FOR FREE CLASSES

Instructors and assistants are entitled to one free class of any type (including Specialty Classes), with one dog, for every class taught in the same session. Instructors and Assistants will receive small Perks Program wallet-size card for each class taught.

- One card will be issued for each class taught by instructors and assistants in each full six or seven-week session.
- You may use that card to pay for a class.
- After you enroll in the class, you will need to turn in one Instructors Perks Program card for each class you take. You must turn it in, with a copy the confirmation email you receive when you enroll, as follows: Either mail in the card (one for each class), or put it in an envelope in the cash box in the office, or give it to the instructor the first week of class.
- There will be six blocks on the back of the card that can be used to pay the fee for a Drop-In to a class, which includes the Saturday Night Fun Classes.
 - If you drop in to a class (with the approval of the instructor of that class) you can present your card to the Instructor and he/she will sign one of the blocks on the back and return the card to you.
 - The instructor will indicate on the roster that Perks were used as payment.
 - If you fail to present the card, you must pay the Drop-In fee.
- The Perks Program Cards will be issued for the five full sessions each year.
- Cards are not transferable, except that they may be used by immediate family members who are listed as part of your KCTC family membership.
- You are responsible for the cards, they cannot be replaced.
- They are valid as long as you are a member.
- If you drop your membership, the cards immediately become invalid.
- The cards cannot be used for Agility and Rally Run-Thrus, cash classes such as the Saturday Morning Open class, Seminars or Workshops, or December short-session classes.
- The cards have no effect on the way Bonus Bones are used. Bonus Bones are for a free class and cannot be used for anything else.

BUILDING USAGE: Instructors (and assistants) may use the building when classes or events or building cleanings are not scheduled, in accordance with the following: First, check the Building Usage schedule on the website to pick a time when the building is free. Then send an e-mail to info@keystonecanine.com with your name and desired time slot (date and time and room [front or back]). The time may not be within one hour of any

scheduled class or event (to allow time for set-up and cleanup for the class or event). Your reservation will be posted to the Building Usage page of the website, and a contact person will confirm your time slot. Please note that any official club events (seminars, trials, run-thrus, etc.) supersede private building usage, even if they are scheduled after you reserve a time slot. If this happens, you will be notified. Building usage is for the private use of instructors and assistants, not for formal lessons or classes, and non-members are not allowed to participate. You may use either room without reserving it in advance, but not if someone else has officially reserved it (as denoted on the Building Usage page of the website).

Our policy on running your dogs in a class you teach:

- You may run your dogs before or after class (if there is no conflict with another class).
- If you choose to run your dog during a class that you are teaching, the dog must be enrolled in that class.

INDIVIDUAL MEMBERSHIP RENEWAL: Instructors and assistants may redeem 5 unused Perks Program Cards within 2 years from date of issue for their yearly club individual membership fee.

APPENDIX D: AGILITY EQUIPMENT POLICY – *DELETED AND RELOCATED TO THE INSTRUCTORS' MANUAL*

APPENDIX E: INSTRUCTOR EXPECTATIONS, APPOINTMENTS, AND PERFORMANCE EVALUATIONS - *DELETED AND RELOCATED TO THE INSTRUCTORS' MANUAL*

APPENDIX F

FACEBOOK AND TWITTER POLICIES

Revision 4-11-16

NOTE: THESE POLICIES APPLY TO THE OFFICIAL KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB GROUP, THE OFFICIAL KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB FACEBOOK PAGE AND THE OFFICIAL KEYSTONE CANINE TRAINING CLUB TWITTER ACCOUNT.

1. The Official Keystone Canine Training Club Facebook Group.

- a. This group was created for dog club members to network, ask questions and get to know one another. This is a private group; members can only be added by administrators. Members of this group should only include club members.
- b. Members of this group may: post questions about the club's classes and events; ask questions about groomers and dog stores in the area; ask 'getting to know you'-type questions, and ask questions about general dog issues and events. We always love seeing interaction between group members; feel free to get to know everyone and ask questions about everything dog!

2. The Official Keystone Canine Training Club Facebook Page.

- a. This group was created for dog club members and those interested in KCTC posts and updates on the latest dog club news, ask questions, and learn.
- b. Members of this page may: comment on/like statuses, photos and event pages for the dog club. This page is meant to be informative AND fun.

3. The Official Keystone Canine Training Club Twitter Account.

- a. This account was created for dog club members to receive updates on the latest dog club news, ask questions, and learn.
 - i. This is an open account. Followers are added as they follow the account. Followers of this account should only include club members and those interested in becoming club members.
 - ii. Followers of this account may: reply to tweets; favorite tweets; retweet tweets.

iii. This account is meant to be informative AND fun.

4. Rules and Regulations

- a. Members of the Facebook group, Facebook page, and Twitter account may NOT: post/comment or tweet about personal issues pertaining to outside problems; problems between club members; problems between members and the club; vent; ask people to promote/work with their private businesses; or request money for philanthropies/events.
- b. Any personal problems should be resolved between individuals outside of the club. Problems between club members should be resolved between themselves, and/or with a member of the club's Board or Directors acting as a neutral third party. Problems between members and the club should be resolved between the individual(s) and the Board of Directors. Venting should be reserved for the individual's personal Facebook page. Promotion of someone's own private business is not appropriate for posting. Promotion of someone's philanthropies/events is also not appropriate for posting.

ANYONE FOUND IN VIOLATION OF THESE POLICIES WILL BE REMOVED AND BANNED FROM THE GROUP, PAGE OR ACCOUNT IMMEDIATELY, NO QUESTIONS ASKED.

APPENDIX G: SESSION PLANNING TIMELINE

Revision 11-13-17

WHEN	ACTION	WHO
6 weeks before session begins	Post session start date and enrollment start date on website. Enrollment start date should be about 2 weeks before the first class of the session.	Website editor
3 weeks before session begins	Post class schedule (with links to enrollment instructions) on the website	Training Director
About 2 weeks before session begins	Change "The Key" Enrollments from Inactive to Active (Note: normally on a Sunday at 9:00 pm)	Enrollment Coordinator
One week after session begins	Change "The Key" enrollments from Active to Inactive	Enrollment Coordinator

APPENDIX H: BONUS BONES PROGRAM

DELETED 1-10-24

APPENDIX I: KCTC INSTRUCTOR EDUCATION PROGRAM REQUIREMENTS

REVISION 3-13-22

In order to encourage our instructors/assistants to take advantage of learning opportunities, we initially offered a reimbursement program in for any dog training seminar/class, in accordance with the following requirements:

- Instructor/assistant must have instructed for 3 sessions in the last 12 months
- Must be a member in good standing
- Subject to approval on an individual basis by 2 board members and the training director
- Offered year to year based on the club's financial condition
- It can be used for seminars (in house/other); or on-line courses or seminars
- Maximum reimbursement is \$50
- Must be about dog training, but not limited to the subjects/areas that the instructor/assistant is teaching
- Instructor/assistant must submit proof of payment to the training director with their request for reimbursement